I Paid 30K A Month For Editors. Now I Pay 2 Subscriptions.

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Nov 12, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/WRUaeMrOwTQ Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter replaced a $20K–$30K/month content editing operation with two AI tool subscriptions (Claude and ChatGPT), increasing output volume — but stresses that AI editing is worthless without strong underlying ideas.

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💸 The Old Editing Setup & Its Cost 0:00

- Was spending **$20,000–$30,000 per month** on content production
  - This was sustained "for years" — not a short-term experiment
  - Maintained a large team: "an army of editors"
    - The operation was layered enough that "my editors had editors" — a multi-tier editorial hierarchy
- Despite the high spend, content volume was relatively low
  - He describes the output as "a way smaller volume" compared to what he produces now

🤖 The AI Switch: Two Subscriptions Replace Everything 0:00

- All content shown in the video was edited entirely with AI tools
- Now relies on exactly two subscriptions:
  - **Claude** (referred to as "Claw" / "Clawude")
  - **ChatGPT** (referred to as "Chad GBT")
- Results of the switch:
  - Dramatically lower costs — from up to $30K/month down to the price of two AI subscriptions
  - Higher content volume than before despite the reduced spend
- Meta-example: the very video being recorded was edited with Claude

💡 The Catch: AI Can't Save Bad Ideas 0:25

- AI handles editing, but idea generation and content quality remain fully human responsibilities
  - "You still have to come up with good ideas. You just have to put out good content."
- The financial stakes of ignoring this:
  - Relying on AI without good ideas means "you're missing millions and millions of dollars"
- Core takeaway: AI is a production efficiency tool, not a creative strategy replacement